LEX-COL · LÉXICO TRANSVERSAL

Collocations y preposiciones dependientes

Teoría: lo que el C2 añade sobre el C1

v1 · octubre de 2026 · 335 combinaciones por estructura y por campo, con su grado de fijación · remisiones a UOE-P1, UOE-P2, UOE-P3, UOE-P4, LEX-IDI y LEX-PHV

Este documento da por sabido el repertorio de collocations del C1 Advanced y recoge lo que el C2 exige de más: combinaciones menos previsibles, intensificadores especializados, verbos que no se deducen del español y preposiciones dependientes de palabras de registro alto. Las secciones 1 y 2 explican cómo se evalúan y qué grado de fijación tiene cada combinación; de la 3 a la 9 van las collocations por estructura (adverbio + adjetivo, adjetivo + sustantivo, verbo + sustantivo…); la 10 reúne las preposiciones dependientes, la 11 las frases preposicionales y los patrones fijos, y la 12 es una tabla de repaso por palabra base. Lo que ya explican UOE-P1, UOE-P2, UOE-P4, LEX-IDI y LEX-PHV no se repite: se remite al final de cada sección. Los verbos con preposición que tienen significado propio (make for, smack of) están en LEX-PHV §14. El asterisco (*) marca formas incorrectas.

1 Cómo se evalúan y cómo usar el documento

1.1 · Dónde aparecen en el examen

Parte	Cómo aparecen	Qué exige
Use of English · Part 1	Las cuatro opciones encajan por significado; decide qué palabra acepta la vecina (stubbornly / *obstinately high) o qué preposición sigue al hueco.	Saber con qué se combina cada palabra y qué estructura exige (UOE-P1 §3 y §6).
Use of English · Part 2	El hueco es la preposición dependiente (immune to, wary of) o la palabra gramatical de una frase fija (under way, at modest cost).	Saberse la preposición; la palabra que la rige puede estar lejos (the extent to which).
Use of English · Part 3	La palabra base se transforma en el colocado: un adverbio intensificador (DECEIVE → deceptively simple) o un adjetivo (an outright ban, a hefty fine).	Conocer el derivado que forma la collocation, no solo el que existe.
Use of English · Part 4	La clave es el sustantivo o el verbo de la collocation; la frase 1 da el verbo llano (compensate → make amends for).	Pasar a verbo + sustantivo con su preposición, sin perder ninguna pieza.
Reading y Listening	Las collocations de registro alto transmiten la actitud (a thinly veiled threat, damning evidence, a vexed question).	Captar la valoración que encierra la combinación.
Writing y Speaking	El criterio de léxico premia la combinación precisa; los calcos (*realise a study, *put attention) restan.	Producir combinaciones idiomáticas y saber cuánto se pueden variar (§2).

1.2 · Qué cambia respecto al C1

Aspecto	C1 Advanced	C2 Proficiency
Repertorio	Collocations frecuentes (make a decision, heavy traffic, highly likely)	Menos previsibles y por campos (stage a comeback, slender evidence, allay fears)

Aspecto	C1 Advanced	C2 Proficiency
Intensificadores	very, really, extremely, highly	Adverbios especializados que además valoran (deceptively, woefully, prohibitively)
Preposiciones	Las frecuentes (interested in, depend on)	Las de palabras de registro alto (commensurate with, privy to) y las que cambian el sentido (glad of / glad about)
Uso	Reconocer la combinación	Producirla y saber qué admite variación y qué no (§2)

1.3 · Cómo leer las tablas

- Cada entrada tiene cinco columnas: la combinación, su grado de fijación (Fij.), su registro (Reg.), el significado en español con las alternativas admitidas y el calco típico, y un ejemplo.
- En negrita, el **colocado**: la palabra que se elige en función de la otra y la que suele suprimirse en la Part 1 o darse como clave en la Part 4. En redonda, la palabra base: **stubbornly** high, **allay** fears, **slender** evidence. Tras la barra, otras bases que admite el colocado: **voice** a view / concern.
- Fijación: ●●● fija (no admite sustituto), ●●○ restringida (solo las alternativas indicadas), ●○○ preferente (hay otras formas correctas, pero esta es la idiomática). Se explica en §2.
- Registro. F: formal o escrito cuidado, adecuado en essay y report. N: neutro. I: informal; en conversación, o en un article o una review de tono ligero, pero no en essay ni report.
- sb (somebody), sth (something) y one's marcan huecos que se rellenan según la frase. En el significado, «no *X» señala el error típico, casi siempre un calco del español.
- **Ya en otra teoría**, al final de cada sección, lista las combinaciones del tema que ya explican otras teorías, con su apartado. Aquí no se repiten.

> CLAVE
> Una collocation no se deduce: la palabra base la eliges por lo que quieres decir (high, evidence, comeback); el colocado lo impone el uso (stubbornly, slender, stage). Se aprende la pareja entera, con su preposición si la lleva, como si fuera una sola palabra.

> ESTRATEGIA DE EXAMEN
> En la Part 1, si las cuatro opciones son sinónimos, no preguntes cuál significa lo que quieres decir (todas lo hacen), sino cuál «va» con la palabra base. En Writing, usa la combinación que has visto; si dudas, una neutra y segura (very high) antes que un intensificador mal colocado (*deeply high).

2 Grado de fijación

No todas las collocations son igual de rígidas. Saber cuánto admite variar cada una sirve para dos cosas: en la Part 1, para descartar el sinónimo que la combinación no admite; en Writing, para saber cuándo hay margen y cuándo una sola palabra es posible.

2.1 · La escala

Grado	Qué significa	Ejemplo	En el examen
Libre	Vale cualquier palabra con el significado adecuado. No se estudia.	a big / large / huge house	No se evalúa.

Grado	Qué significa	Ejemplo	En el examen
●○○ Preferente	Hay varias formas correctas, pero una es la idiomática y las demás suenan forzadas o son raras.	stubbornly high (también persistently high; very high, neutro)	Writing y Speaking: suma precisión. En la Part 1 solo si los distractores no forman combinación.
●●○ Restringida	Solo unas pocas palabras, enumerables. Cualquier otra, aunque sea sinónima, falla.	stage / make / mount a comeback; voice / express / air a view	Part 1: el distractor es el sinónimo que no está en la lista.
●●● Fija	Una sola forma, con su artículo y su número. Ningún sinónimo.	make amends (plural); under way (sin artículo); running costs	Part 1, 2 y 4: cualquier cambio cuesta el punto o la mitad.

2.2 · Cómo reconocer el grado

1. **¿El colocado tiene aquí su sentido literal?** Si no lo tiene, la combinación es restringida o fija: stage no es «escenificar» en stage a comeback, ni slender es «delgado» en slender evidence.
2. **¿Admite un sinónimo del colocado?** make / stage a comeback sí; *carry the brunt no (UOE-P1 §3.1).
3. **¿Admite cambios gramaticales?** Las fijas casi ninguno: the brunt siempre con artículo, amends siempre en plural, under way siempre sin artículo, to call siempre en activa (too close to call).
4. **¿Aparece en otras combinaciones con el mismo sentido?** Si el colocado se repite con una familia de bases (fiercely con independent, loyal, competitive, protective), aprende la familia: es restringida pero productiva.

2.3 · Por qué no se deducen: la palabra base manda

El colocado no se elige por su significado, sino por la palabra base. Por eso el español engaña: traducir el verbo o el adjetivo palabra por palabra produce combinaciones que se entienden pero que ningún nativo usa. Son los errores que más delatan en Writing:

Calco	Forma correcta	Español
*realise a study	carry out / conduct a study	realizar un estudio
*give a conference	give / deliver a lecture	dar una conferencia (conference = congreso)
*put / lend attention	pay attention	prestar atención
*make a question / *do a question	ask a question	hacer una pregunta
*commit a mistake	make a mistake	cometer un error (commit va con a crime, an offence)
*give a step	take a step	dar un paso
*strong rain / *strong traffic	heavy rain / heavy traffic	lluvia fuerte, tráfico denso
*say a lie	tell a lie	decir una mentira
*rise a question	raise a question	plantear una cuestión (rise no lleva objeto)
*make an exam	sit / take an exam	hacer un examen (británico)
*win a living	earn / make a living	ganarse la vida

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Un error de collocation casi nunca impide entender el texto, y por eso pasa desapercibido al revisar. Pero en la Part 1 es exactamente lo que se evalúa, y en Writing es lo que separa un C1 de un C2 en el criterio de léxico. Si una combinación te «suena» porque su traducción es natural en español, desconfía.

3 Adverbio + adjetivo

Es el terreno más característico del C2: el C1 se conforma con very o extremely; el C2 usa adverbios que, además de intensificar, valoran (woefully inadequate critica; refreshingly honest elogia). Los intensificadores de UOE-P1 §3.3 (bitterly, flatly, highly, deeply…) no se repiten.

3.1 · Intensificadores especializados

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
a · Persistencia, firmeza y apariencia				
stubbornly high / persistent	●○○	N	obstinadamente: que no baja o no cede pese a los esfuerzos (inflación, paro, una tasa); también persistently high	Unemployment remains stubbornly high in the north.
fiercely independent / loyal / competitive	●●○	N	con orgullo y energía; no *strongly independent	The islanders are fiercely independent.
deceptively simple / spacious	●●○	N	engañosamente: con simple, parece fácil y no lo es; con spacious, es más amplio de lo que parece	The rules are deceptively simple, but the game takes years to master.
seemingly endless / innocuous	●○○	N	aparentemente (y quizá no lo sea)	A seemingly innocuous remark sparked a furious row.
outwardly calm / confident	●●○	N	por fuera, en apariencia (y por dentro no)	Outwardly calm, she was in fact terrified.
b · Valoración: elogio y crítica				
quietly brilliant / confident / effective	●○○	N	discretamente, sin alardes (elogio)	It is a quietly brilliant novel that deserves a wider audience.
refreshingly honest / free of jargon	●●○	N	agradablemente, por contraste con lo habitual	The report is refreshingly free of jargon.
eminently sensible / reasonable / qualified	●●○	F	sumamente (elogio de lo razonable)	It seems an eminently sensible suggestion.
woefully inadequate / ill-prepared	●●○	N	lamentablemente (crítica dura)	The flood defences proved woefully inadequate.
hopelessly outdated / lost / in love	●●○	N	sin remedio	The software is hopelessly outdated.
singularly unhelpful / ill-suited	●●○	F	excepcionalmente; con negativos, de forma llamativa	He gave a singularly unhelpful reply.
patently false / absurd / obvious	●●○	F	manifiestamente, a la vista de todos	The claim is patently false.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
faintly ridiculous / pompous / absurd	●●○	N	ligeramente (con crítica irónica)	In uniform, he looked faintly ridiculous.
c · Diferencia, coste y riesgo				
strikingly similar / beautiful	●●○	N	llamativamente	The two paintings are strikingly similar.
markedly different / better	●●○	F	notablemente (diferencias medibles)	Results this year are markedly better.
fundamentally flawed / different	●●○	N	en lo esencial; deeply flawed también vale	The study is fundamentally flawed.
prohibitively expensive / high	●●●	N	tan caro que resulta prohibitivo	Rents in the centre are prohibitively expensive.
notoriously difficult / unreliable	●●○	N	como es bien sabido (con mala fama)	Election results are notoriously difficult to predict.
inherently risky / unstable	●●○	F	intrínsecamente, por su propia naturaleza	Any new venture is inherently risky.
dangerously close / low	●●○	N	peligrosamente	Reserves are dangerously low.
d · Emoción y conciencia				
acutely aware / embarrassed	●●○	N	agudamente, muy (de forma casi dolorosa)	She was acutely aware of being watched.
profoundly moving / grateful / shocked	●●○	F	profundamente	It was a profoundly moving ceremony.
thoroughly enjoyable / deserved / ashamed	●●○	N	totalmente (con valoración)	It was a thoroughly enjoyable evening.
mildly amused / surprised / irritating	●●○	N	levemente	She seemed only mildly surprised by the news.
vaguely familiar / aware	●●○	N	vagamente	His face looked vaguely familiar.
vitally / **critically** important	●●○	N	de importancia vital; no *deeply important	It is vitally important that nobody is told.

3.2 · Adjetivos graduables y no graduables

Los intensificadores se reparten según el adjetivo admita grados o sea ya extremo o absoluto. Mezclarlos es un error que el examinador detecta enseguida.

Tipo de adjetivo	Intensificadores	Ejemplos	No vale
Graduable (difficult, cold, surprised)	very, extremely, incredibly, terribly y los de §3.1	extremely difficult, mildly surprised	*absolutely difficult, *utterly cold
Extremo (freezing, exhausted, furious, appalling)	absolutely, utterly, totally, completely, quite	absolutely freezing, utterly exhausted	*very freezing, *extremely furious

Tipo de adjetivo	Intensificadores	Ejemplos	No vale
Absoluto (impossible, perfect, wrong, unique)	completely, totally, entirely; para atenuar, almost, virtually	virtually impossible, entirely wrong	*very impossible, *quite unique en el sentido de «bastante»

- quite cambia de sentido: con un graduable atenúa (quite good, bastante bueno, en británico); con un extremo o absoluto intensifica (quite extraordinary, quite right: totalmente).
- utterly va sobre todo con adjetivos negativos (utterly ridiculous, utterly miserable); rather, con negativos o sorprendentes (rather disappointing), y fairly, con positivos o neutros (fairly good).
- Los intensificadores del comparativo (far, considerably, a great deal) están en UOE-P4 §3.7.

3.3 · Grado con sustantivos

El grado también se expresa delante de un sustantivo. Son fórmulas muy frecuentes en el registro periodístico y en Speaking, y la Part 2 suprime a menudo su palabra gramatical.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
something of a + sust.	●●●	N	en cierto modo, bastante (atenúa)	He is something of a showman.
more of a X (than a Y)	●●●	N	más bien	It is more of a guideline than a rule.
very much a + sust.	●●●	N	totalmente, sin duda	She is very much a politician of the old school.
not much of a + sust.	●●●	I	no muy bueno como	I'm not much of a cook.
every inch a + sust.	●●●	N	de los pies a la cabeza	He was every inch a soldier.
no mean + sust.	●●●	N	nada despreciable; sobre todo no mean feat / achievement	Finishing the marathon was no mean feat.

Ya en otra teoría: bitterly disappointed, deeply hurt, highly unlikely, painfully obvious, readily available, sorely missed (UOE-P1 §3.3) · quite a, such a (UOE-P2 §3) · a bit of a + noun (UOE-P4 §7) · far / considerably + comparative (UOE-P4 §3.7)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 1

The rules of the game are _____ simple: a child can learn them in a minute, yet even seasoned players take years to master it.

A deceptively **B** falsely **C** wrongly **D** mistakenly

Respuesta: A · deceptively**.** Deceptively simple: parece sencillo y no lo es; yet confirma el contraste entre apariencia y realidad.

B falsely: falsely va con verbos (falsely accused, falsely claim), no con adjetivos de cualidad.

C wrongly: wrongly modifica verbos (wrongly convicted); *wrongly simple no existe.

D mistakenly: mistakenly significa «por error» y también va con verbos (mistakenly believed).

4 Adverbio + verbo y participio

El adverbio precisa cómo se hace algo y, sobre todo, cuánto. Ante un participio usado como adjetivo aparecen combinaciones muy fijas del registro periodístico (hotly contested, much-publicised).

4.1 · Adverbio + verbo

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
a · Negar, rechazar, afirmar				
categorically deny / reject / rule out	●●○	F	categóricamente	The minister categorically denied the allegations.
strenuously deny / object	●●○	F	enérgicamente	The company strenuously denies any wrongdoing.
steadfastly refuse / maintain	●●○	F	con firmeza inquebrantable	He steadfastly maintained his innocence.
wholeheartedly agree / support	●●○	N	de todo corazón, sin reservas	I wholeheartedly agree with you.
freely admit / acknowledge	●●○	N	sin reparos	I freely admit that I was wrong.
b · Recordar y percibir				
vividly remember / recall / describe	●●○	N	con viveza	I vividly remember my first day at school.
dimly / **vaguely** remember / recall	●●○	N	vagamente	I dimly recall meeting him once.
fondly remember / recall	●●○	N	con cariño	She is fondly remembered by her pupils.
fully appreciate / understand	●○○	N	plenamente	I fully appreciate your concerns.
c · Grado, proximidad y resultado				
sharply criticise / rise / fall	●●○	N	con dureza; bruscamente (cifras)	The decision was sharply criticised.
heavily criticise / rely on / depend on	●●○	N	mucho; no *strongly rely on	The region relies heavily on tourism.
closely resemble / follow / monitor	●●○	N	de cerca, mucho	The plot closely resembles that of an earlier novel.
narrowly avoid / escape / miss / defeat	●●○	N	por poco	The two cars narrowly avoided a collision.
greatly appreciate / exaggerate	●○○	N	mucho; greatly exaggerated, muy exagerado	Reports of his death were greatly exaggerated.
painstakingly restore / reconstruct	●●○	N	con esmero, minuciosamente	The frescoes have been painstakingly restored.

4.2 · Adverbio + participio adjetival

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
highly prized / acclaimed / skilled	●●○	N	muy (valorado, aclamado, cualificado)	Local honey is highly prized by chefs.
much-publicised / -loved / -needed / -maligned	●●○	N	muy (solo ante sustantivo, con guion)	the much-publicised launch of the new model
hotly contested / debated / disputed	●●○	N	reñido, muy discutido	It was a hotly contested election.
thinly veiled / disguised	●●○	N	apenas disimulado	The speech was a thinly veiled attack on the government.
richly deserved / rewarded	●●○	N	más que merecido	Her award was richly deserved.
deeply rooted / ingrained / entrenched	●●○	N	muy arraigado	Such prejudices are deeply ingrained.
densely / **sparsely** populated	●●○	N	muy / poco poblado; no *highly populated	a sparsely populated region
heavily guarded / subsidised / indebted	●●○	N	fuertemente, muy	The industry is heavily subsidised.
conspicuously absent	●●●	F	llamativamente ausente	Senior ministers were conspicuously absent from the ceremony.
long overdue / awaited / forgotten	●●○	N	desde hace mucho; long-awaited ante sustantivo	The reform is long overdue.
close-knit / **tight-knit** community	●●●	N	muy unido	It is a close-knit community.

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Los adverbios en -ly nunca llevan guion: a highly prized stamp, no *a highly-prized stamp. Los demás (much, well, long, ill) lo llevan ante sustantivo y lo pierden detrás del verbo: a much-needed rest / the rest was much needed. La grafía de los compuestos está en UOE-P3 §7.4.

Ya en otra teoría: flatly refuse, roundly criticise, readily admit, vehemently deny, highly regarded (UOE-P1 §3.3) · ill-advised (UOE-P3 §7.4)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 1

The letter contained a thinly _____ threat to withdraw funding if the article was published.

A veiled **B** covered **C** hidden **D** masked

Respuesta: A · veiled. Thinly veiled: apenas disimulado. Es la collocation fija con threat, attack o criticism (también thinly disguised).

B covered: covered tiene aquí su sentido literal (cubierto); *thinly covered threat no existe.

C hidden: hidden va con barely o carefully (carefully hidden), no con thinly.

D masked: masked forma barely masked hostility; con thinly no es idiomático.

5 Adjetivo + sustantivo, por campos

El adjetivo lo impone el sustantivo: slender evidence, pero a slim chance (UOE-P1 §3.2) y a narrow margin. Se agrupan por el campo en que aparecen en los textos del examen; los compuestos de dos sustantivos (a status symbol, a turning point) van al final.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
a · Pruebas, argumentos y conocimiento				
slender / **slim** / **flimsy** evidence	●●○	N	pruebas escasas o endebles; también the evidence is thin	The case rests on slender evidence.
damning evidence / verdict / report	●●○	N	demoledor, que condena sin paliativos	The report is a damning indictment of the prison service.
compelling / **hard** evidence	●●○	N	convincente / concluyente, tangible	There is no hard evidence that the drug works.
a **settled** fact / view	●●○	N	establecido, que ya no se discute	It was regarded as a settled fact that the earth was flat.
an **unspoken** assumption / rule	●●○	N	tácito, que nadie formula	There was an unspoken assumption that she would take over.
a **convenient** excuse / scapegoat	●○○	N	socorrido, que viene bien	The weather provided a convenient excuse.
a **tenuous** link / connection	●●○	N	tenue, rebuscado	The link between the two cases is tenuous at best.
a **cogent** argument / case	●●○	F	convincente y bien razonado	She made a cogent case for reform.
a **vexed** question / issue	●●○	F	espinoso, muy debatido	the vexed question of funding
a **moot** point	●●●	F	discutible; también, ya sin interés práctico	Whether it was legal is a moot point.
conventional / **received** wisdom	●●○	N	la opinión comúnmente aceptada	Conventional wisdom holds that prices will fall.
rival strategies / theories / claims	●○○	N	que compiten entre sí; también competing	Two rival theories have been put forward.
b · Cantidad, proporción y alcance				
a **sizeable** / **significant** minority	●●○	N	una minoría considerable	A sizeable minority voted against the plan.
an **overwhelming** / a **vast** majority	●●○	N	una aplastante / amplísima mayoría	An overwhelming majority supported the motion.
an **outright** ban / winner / majority	●●○	N	total, sin paliativos; outright winner: claro vencedor	The council has imposed an outright ban on fireworks.
a **blanket** ban	●●●	N	general, sin excepciones	a blanket ban on mobile phones in schools
a **token** gesture / payment	●●○	N	simbólico, por cubrir el expediente	The fine is little more than a token gesture.
a **nominal** fee / charge	●●○	N	simbólico (un precio muy bajo)	Members pay a nominal fee.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
c · Sentimientos, recuerdos y relaciones				
acute homesickness / anxiety / embarrassment	●●○	N	intenso (sentimiento); acute shortage, en UOE-P1 §3.2	In her first term she suffered from acute homesickness.
cherished / **fond** memories	●●○	N	entrañable, muy querido	I have fond memories of those summers.
a **vague** / **hazy** / **distant** recollection	●●○	N	un recuerdo vago, lejano	I have only a hazy recollection of the accident.
deep-seated / **deep-rooted** fears / prejudice	●●○	N	muy arraigado	deep-seated fears about immigration
grudging respect / admiration	●●●	N	a regañadientes	She earned the grudging respect of her rivals.
simmering resentment / tension	●●○	N	latente, a punto de estallar	simmering tension between the two communities
an **acrimonious** / a **bitter** dispute	●●○	N	enconado	an acrimonious divorce
d · Política, normas y conflicto				
a **staunch** supporter / ally / opponent	●●○	N	acérrimo, incondicional	He was a staunch supporter of the monarchy.
a **vocal** critic / minority	●●○	N	que se hace oír	She has been a vocal critic of the policy.
a **common** enemy / cause	●○○	N	común; united by a common enemy	The two factions were united by a common enemy.
a **heated** debate / argument	●●○	N	acalorado	The proposal provoked a heated debate.
a **landslide** victory	●●●	N	aplastante (en unas elecciones)	The party won a landslide victory.
a **public** admission / apology	●○○	N	público	His resignation was a public admission of failure.
a **bureaucratic** / **logistical** nightmare	●●○	N	una pesadilla burocrática / logística	Moving the archive was a logistical nightmare.
a **level** playing field	●●●	N	igualdad de condiciones	Smaller firms want a level playing field.
hard-won rights / independence	●●○	N	conseguido con mucho esfuerzo	They will not give up their hard-won rights.
e · Dinero y economía				
running costs	●●●	N	gastos de funcionamiento o mantenimiento	Electric cars have lower running costs.
hidden costs / charges	●●○	N	ocultos, que no se anuncian	Beware of hidden charges.
a **hefty** fine / bill / price	●●○	N	abultado, considerable	The firm faces a hefty fine.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
a **lucrative** contract / deal / career	●●○	N	lucrativo	He turned down a lucrative contract.
a **tidy** sum / profit	●●●	I	una buena suma	They sold the house for a tidy sum.
disposable income	●●●	N	renta disponible (tras impuestos y gastos fijos)	Households have less disposable income.
a **windfall** tax / profit	●●○	N	beneficio caído del cielo; impuesto sobre él	a windfall tax on energy companies
f · Sustantivo + sustantivo				
a **status** symbol	●●●	N	símbolo de estatus	A car is no longer a status symbol.
a **turning** point	●●●	N	punto de inflexión; no *a turnaround point	The election marked a turning point in the country's history.
a **dramatic** turnaround	●●○	N	giro radical (a mejor)	The firm has staged a dramatic turnaround.
a **sticking** point / a **stumbling** block	●●●	N	escollo (en una negociación) / obstáculo	Pay remains the main sticking point.
a **vicious** circle	●●●	N	círculo vicioso (en americano, vicious cycle)	Poverty and poor health form a vicious circle.
a **knock-on** effect	●●●	N	efecto en cadena (británico)	The strike had a knock-on effect on other industries.
a **track** record	●●●	N	historial, trayectoria demostrada	She has a proven track record in management.
a **steep** learning curve	●●●	N	un aprendizaje duro y rápido	The first year was a steep learning curve.
lifelong learning	●●●	N	formación continua, a lo largo de la vida	The university promotes lifelong learning.
a **household** name	●●●	N	un nombre conocido por todos	By thirty she was a household name.
a **safety** net	●●●	N	red de seguridad (también fig.)	Benefits act as a safety net.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Tres adjetivos de «poco» con bases distintas: slender o slim con evidence, chance y majority; narrow con margin, escape y majority; scant con sustantivos abstractos (scant attention). Y a bitter rival no es *a bitter opponent of the policy: para posturas, staunch o vocal.

Ya en otra teoría: a heavy toll, a slim chance, stiff competition, an acute shortage, a rough estimate, a vested interest, a foregone conclusion, a sweeping generalisation (UOE-P1 §3.2) · a bone of contention (LEX-IDI §8) · a white elephant, a cash cow (LEX-IDI §13)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 1

Despite years of research, the evidence linking the additive to the illness remains _____, and few scientists are prepared to draw firm conclusions.

A slender **B** narrow **C** lean **D** fine

Respuesta: A · slender. Slender evidence: pruebas escasas, insuficientes. Few scientists are prepared to draw firm conclusions lo confirma.

B narrow: narrow va con margin, escape o majority, no con evidence.

C lean: lean forma lean times, a lean year (de escasez económica); no se aplica a pruebas.

D fine: fine forma a fine line o a fine distinction; *fine evidence no significa «escasa».

6 Verbo + sustantivo, por campos

Es la collocation que más rinde en la Part 1 y en la Part 4: el sustantivo se mantiene y el verbo es el hueco, o al revés. Los verbos de significado débil (make, take, keep, bear…) tienen sección propia (§7).

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
a · Opinión, discurso y reacciones				
voice a view / concern / doubts	●●○	N	expresar, manifestar; también express, air	Several members voiced concern about the cost.
air one's views / grievances	●●○	N	airear, hacer públicas (quejas, opiniones)	The meeting gave staff a chance to air their grievances.
allay fears / concerns / suspicions	●●○	F	disipar, calmar	The minister tried to allay fears of job losses.
fuel speculation / fears / anger	●●○	N	avivar, alimentar	His absence fuelled speculation that he was ill.
spark controversy / a debate / protests	●●○	N	desatar, provocar	The decision sparked controversy.
draw criticism / fire	●●○	N	atraer, recibir (críticas)	The plan has drawn criticism from all sides.
level criticism / accusations at sb	●●○	F	dirigir (críticas, acusaciones) contra alguien	Much of the criticism was levelled at the board.
b · Éxito, fracaso y competición				
stage / **make** / **mount** a comeback	●●○	N	volver por todo lo alto, resurgir; no *perform a comeback	After two years out, she staged a remarkable comeback.
win a contract / an award / sb's support	●○○	N	conseguir; no *gain a contract	The firm has won a contract to build the bridge.
cross the threshold	●●○	N	cruzar el umbral (entrar); superar el umbral (de una cifra)	Few visitors ever crossed the threshold. · Inflation has crossed the 5% threshold.
clinch a deal / victory / title	●●○	N	cerrar, asegurarse	A late goal clinched the title.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
reap the rewards / benefits	●●○	N	cosechar (los frutos)	We are now reaping the rewards of years of investment.
suffer a setback / defeat	●●○	N	sufrir; no *have a defeat	The campaign suffered a serious setback.
meet with success / resistance	●●○	F	encontrar, topar con	The proposal met with fierce resistance.
c · Normas, instituciones y justicia				
commission a report / study / artist	●●○	N	encargar	The council commissioned a report on the problem.
impose / **lift** a ban / restrictions	●●○	N	imponer / levantar; no *put a ban	The ban was lifted after a year.
enforce a law / rule / ban	●●○	N	hacer cumplir	The rule is rarely enforced.
flout the rules / the law	●●○	N	saltarse a la torera, abiertamente	Some drivers openly flout the law.
go to court (over sth)	●●●	N	ir a juicio (por algo); sin artículo	The two firms went to court over the patent.
lodge / **file** a complaint	●●○	N	presentar (una queja formal); lodge, británico	She lodged a formal complaint.
set a precedent	●●●	N	sentar un precedente	The ruling could set a dangerous precedent.
harden attitudes / one's stance	●●○	N	endurecer (posturas)	The attack only hardened attitudes on both sides.
waive a fee / one's right	●●○	F	renunciar a, eximir de	The bank agreed to waive the fee.
d · Culpa y responsabilidad				
lay / **put** / **place** the blame (squarely) on sb	●●○	N	echar la culpa (de lleno) a alguien; también lay the blame at sb's door	The report lays the blame squarely on the management.
bear / **shoulder** / **take** the blame (for)	●●○	N	cargar con la culpa	Junior staff were made to bear the blame.
apportion blame	●●●	F	repartir las culpas	The inquiry was not set up to apportion blame.
shift / **pass** the blame (onto sb)	●●○	N	echar la culpa a otro	He tried to shift the blame onto his deputy.
claim / **accept** responsibility (for)	●●○	N	claim: reivindicar (un atentado); accept: asumir	No group has claimed responsibility for the attack.
admit liability	●●●	F	reconocer la responsabilidad legal	The company has admitted liability.
e · Riesgo, efectos y consecuencias				

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
carry a risk / a penalty	●●○	N	conllevar; carry less risk, entrañar menos riesgo	The operation carries a small risk.
run the risk of -ing	●●●	N	correr el riesgo de	You run the risk of losing everything.
breed resentment / contempt / complacency	●●○	N	engendrar, fomentar; familiarity breeds contempt	Secrecy breeds suspicion.
compound a problem / the effects	●●○	F	agravar algo que ya era malo	The drought was compounded by a heatwave.
fall (hardest / heavily) **on** sb	●●○	N	recaer (con más fuerza) sobre	The cuts will fall hardest on the poorest families.
weigh up the options / the evidence	●●○	N	sopesar (phrasal con objetos fijos)	We need to weigh up the pros and cons.
strike / **reach** a compromise	●●○	N	llegar a una solución de compromiso	The two sides struck a compromise.
f · Oficio, habilidad y tradición				
learn / **hone** one's craft	●●○	N	aprender / pulir el oficio	She learnt her craft in provincial theatres.
keep a skill / a tradition **alive**	●●○	N	mantener vivo	A few families keep the skill alive.
keep sth **alight**	●●○	N	mantener encendido (un fuego; fig., la esperanza, el interés)	A late goal kept their hopes alight.
uphold a tradition / a principle	●●○	F	mantener, defender	The court upheld the principle of free speech.
break with tradition	●●●	N	romper con la tradición (sin artículo)	Breaking with tradition, she wore red.
acquire a taste for	●●●	N	coger el gusto a	He acquired a taste for opera late in life.
fit sb **into a slot**	●●○	N	encasillar a alguien en una categoría	Critics struggled to fit her into a neat slot.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Con blame, el verbo decide quién la recibe: se lays, puts o places la culpa on otro; se bears, shoulders o takes uno mismo. *Bear the blame on sb mezcla las dos construcciones.

Ya en otra teoría: pose a threat, wield power, exert pressure, harbour doubts, strike a balance, incur costs, bear the brunt of, jog sb's memory (UOE-P1 §3.1) · squarely blame (UOE-P1 §3.3) · pay tribute to, take its toll on, draw attention to, give rise to (UOE-P4 §5.1) · carry weight, hold sway (LEX-IDI §7)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 4

According to the report, the management was entirely responsible for the accident.

BLAME

The report _____ for the accident.

Respuesta: LAYS THE BLAME SQUARELY ON THE MANAGEMENT (7 palabras)

También: PUTS o PLACES en lugar de LAYS; ENTIRELY o FIRMLY en lugar de SQUARELY · LAYS ALL THE BLAME ON THE MANAGEMENT (7) · LAYS THE BLAME AT THE MANAGEMENT'S DOOR (7)

Qué se puntúa: la collocation con su verbo (lays the blame, no *bears the blame on) y la preposición con el intensificador que recoge entirely (squarely on the management; sin intensificador se pierde esa mitad). BLAMES no vale: cambia la palabra clave.

7 Verbos delexicales

Make, do, take, give, have, pay, keep, bear, lay y hold apenas significan nada por sí mismos: el significado lo pone el sustantivo, y el verbo lo impone la collocation. Por eso son la primera fuente de calcos (*do amends, *make justice). Cada uno tiende a un tipo de sentido, lo que ayuda a recordar el reparto:

Verbo	Qué suele aportar	Ejemplos
make	producir un resultado o un cambio	make amends, make inroads, make a living
do	una acción con efecto sobre alguien o algo	do justice to, do sb a disservice, do wonders
take	adoptar, asumir algo	take a stance, take precedence, take stock
give	provocar algo en otro o concedérselo	give credence to, give sb pause, give sb a say
pay	dar lo que se debe	pay heed, pay dividends, pay the price
keep	mantener en un estado	keep track of, keep sth in check, keep tabs on
bear	llevar, soportar, producir	bear fruit, bear witness to, bear a resemblance to
hold	mantener; celebrar	hold sb's attention, hold talks, hold office

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
a · make y do				
make amends (to sb) (for sth)	●●●	N	reparar el daño, compensar; siempre en plural; no *do amends, *make an amend	He wrote to her to make amends for his behaviour.
make a statement	●●○	N	1 hacer una declaración (formal: issue a statement); 2 transmitir un mensaje, llamar la atención (ropa, un edificio)	The new museum makes a bold statement about the city's ambitions.
make / **earn** a living	●●○	N	ganarse la vida; no *win a living	She makes a living as a translator.
make inroads into / on	●●●	N	abrirse paso en, ir ganando terreno	Online retailers have made deep inroads into the high street.
make a habit of -ing	●●●	N	acostumbrar a; make a point of (UOE-P4) es «hacer adrede»	I don't make a habit of arriving late.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
make a killing	●●●	I	forrarse en un negocio	Speculators made a killing on the deal.
do justice to sb / sth	●●●	N	hacer justicia, reflejar fielmente; también do sb / sth justice	The photographs don't do justice to the view.
do sb a disservice	●●●	N	perjudicar, hacer un flaco favor	You do yourself a disservice by underestimating your work.
do / **work** wonders (for)	●●○	N	obrar maravillas	A week by the sea did wonders for her health.
do one's utmost	●●●	N	hacer todo lo posible	We will do our utmost to help.
b · take, have y give				
take effect	●●●	N	entrar en vigor; surtir efecto	The new rules take effect in January.
take precedence (over)	●●●	F	tener prioridad (sobre)	Safety must take precedence over speed.
take stock (of)	●●●	N	hacer balance	It is time to take stock of what we have achieved.
take a stand / stance (on)	●●○	N	adoptar una postura (firme)	The party has yet to take a stance on the issue.
take the view that	●●●	F	considerar que	The court took the view that the contract was void.
have reservations (about)	●●●	N	tener reservas	I have serious reservations about the plan.
have / **give** sb an edge (over)	●●○	N	llevar / dar ventaja	Her experience gives her an edge over the other candidates.
have a field day	●●●	I	darse un festín (la prensa, los críticos)	The tabloids had a field day with the story.
give sb a say (in sth)	●●●	N	dar voz a alguien (en una decisión); have a say in, en UOE-P4	The reform gives parents a say in how schools are run.
give credence to	●●●	F	dar crédito a, hacer creíble	The new evidence gives credence to her account.
give vent to	●●●	F	dar rienda suelta a (la ira, la frustración)	Fans gave vent to their anger online.
give the lie to	●●●	F	desmentir, demostrar que es falso	These figures give the lie to the government's claims.
give sb pause (for thought)	●●●	N	dar que pensar	The results should give us all pause for thought.
c · pay y keep				
pay / **take** heed (of / to)	●●○	F	hacer caso de; pay heed to, take heed of	Few paid heed to the warnings.
pay dividends	●●●	N	dar fruto, compensar	The extra training paid dividends.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
pay the price (for)	●●●	N	pagar las consecuencias	We are now paying the price for years of neglect.
keep track of	●●●	N	llevar la cuenta de, seguir de cerca; lo contrario, lose track of (UOE-P4)	It is hard to keep track of all the changes.
keep tabs on	●●●	I	vigilar, tener controlado	The police kept tabs on him for months.
keep sth in check	●●●	N	mantener a raya	Inflation has been kept in check.
keep a straight face	●●●	I	aguantarse la risa	I could barely keep a straight face.
d · bear, lay, hold y run				
bear a passing / striking resemblance to	●●○	N	parecerse vagamente / mucho a; la collocation base, en UOE-P4 §4	The plot bears a passing resemblance to Hamlet.
bear comparison with	●●●	N	resistir la comparación con; suele ir con well o en negativa	Her new novel bears comparison with her best work.
bear fruit	●●●	N	dar fruto	Their efforts are beginning to bear fruit.
bear witness to	●●●	F	dar fe de, demostrar	The ruins bear witness to the city's former wealth.
lay the foundations (for)	●●○	N	sentar las bases; también lay the groundwork	The treaty laid the foundations for peace.
rest on narrow / shaky foundations	●●○	N	estar mal fundamentado (un argumento, una teoría)	The whole theory rests on narrow foundations.
lay claim to	●●●	F	reivindicar	Several towns lay claim to being his birthplace.
hold sb's attention / interest	●●○	N	mantener la atención; capture o grab la captan	The lecture failed to hold the students' attention.
hold office / talks / an inquiry	●●○	N	ocupar (un cargo); celebrar (conversaciones, una investigación)	Talks will be held next week.
run its course	●●●	N	seguir su curso hasta acabar	The illness must run its course.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Make y do no se intercambian por el sentido, sino por el sustantivo: make amends pero do justice; make a mistake pero do sb a favour. Y take a decision es correcto en británico, aunque make a decision es más frecuente: no es un calco.

Ya en otra teoría: take sth into account, take exception to, take issue with, make allowances for, make a point of -ing, make the most of, lose track of, keep pace with, have a say in (UOE-P4 §5.1) · bear a resemblance to, make an effort (UOE-P4 §4) · make headway (LEX-IDI §3) · pay lip service to (LEX-IDI §8)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 4

He tried hard to compensate for the way he had treated his sister.

AMENDS

He tried hard _____ the way he had treated his sister.

Respuesta: TO MAKE AMENDS FOR (4 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: el verbo delexical correcto (to make amends; *to do amends no existe) y la preposición que introduce la causa (for). AMENDS va siempre en plural.

8 Verbo + adjetivo: verbos de cambio y de estado

Become siempre es gramatical, pero en el C2 se espera el verbo idiomático, que además dice cómo se produce el cambio:

Verbo	Matiz	Ejemplos
go	cambio negativo o involuntario	go bankrupt, go missing, go unnoticed
grow	cambio gradual; algo formal	grow weary, grow old, grow fond of
turn	cambio brusco de estado o de color	turn sour, turn nasty, turn grey
fall	entrada súbita en un estado	fall silent, fall ill, fall asleep
come	resultado final; soltarse	come true, come loose, come undone
run	agotarse o descontrolarse	run dry, run short, run high, run wild
prove	resultar, una vez comprobado	prove costly, prove fatal, prove elusive
hold, lie, ring	permanecer; sonar	hold steady, lie idle, ring true

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
fall silent / ill / asleep	●●○	N	quedarse en silencio de golpe; caer enfermo; no *fall in silence	The room fell silent as she entered.
go unnoticed / unpunished / unchallenged	●●○	N	pasar desapercibido, quedar impune, sin réplica; no *become unnoticed	The error went unnoticed for years.
go missing / bankrupt / blind	●●○	N	desaparecer; quebrar; quedarse ciego; no *get bankrupt	Two files have gone missing.
grow weary / tired of	●●○	F	ir cansándose de	Voters have grown weary of broken promises.
run dry / short / high / wild	●●○	N	agotarse (una fuente); escasear; estar exaltados (los ánimos); desmandarse	Feelings were running high.
wear thin	●●●	N	agotarse (la paciencia); resultar cansino (un chiste, una excusa)	His excuses are wearing thin.
hold steady	●●○	N	mantenerse estable (cifras, el pulso)	Interest rates held steady.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
hold true / good (for)	●●○	N	seguir siendo válido (para)	The same principle holds true for small firms.
ring true / hollow	●●●	N	sonar convincente / a falso	Her apology rang hollow.
come true / loose / undone	●●○	N	hacerse realidad; soltarse; desbaratarse	His worst fears came true.
turn sour / nasty	●●○	N	agriarse; ponerse feo	The relationship soon turned sour.
prove costly / fatal / elusive	●●○	N	resultar (caro, mortal, difícil de alcanzar)	The mistake proved costly.
lie dormant / idle / empty	●●○	N	permanecer inactivo, parado, vacío	The factory has lain idle for years.
break free / loose	●●○	N	liberarse, soltarse	The boat broke loose from its moorings.
plead guilty / not guilty	●●●	N	declararse culpable / inocente	He pleaded guilty to fraud.
make sth **stick**	●●●	N	conseguir que algo arraigue o se sostenga (un hábito, una acusación)	The hard part is making new habits stick.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Go + participio con un- es un patrón productivo del C2: go unnoticed, go unpunished, go unreported, go unanswered, go unchecked. Ni become ni remain tienen el mismo matiz de «sin que nadie haga nada».

Ya en otra teoría: fall flat, make headway (LEX-IDI §3)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 1

For more than a decade the error _____ unnoticed, until a student checking the original data finally spotted it.

A went **B** fell **C** turned **D** came

Respuesta: A • went. Go unnoticed: pasar desapercibido. Go + participio con un- indica que algo ocurre o sigue sin que nadie reaccione.

B fell: fall marca la entrada súbita en un estado (fall silent, fall ill), no se combina con participios en un-.

C turned: turn indica un cambio brusco de estado (turn sour); *turned unnoticed no existe.

D came: come va con resultados (come true, come loose); *came unnoticed no existe.

9 Sustantivo + of: grupos, cantidades y matices

Los sustantivos de cantidad o de grupo eligen qué pueden cuantificar, y muchos añaden una valoración (a plethora, demasiados; a catalogue of errors, con reproche). UOE-P1 §3.4 trata los más frecuentes (a pang of, a flicker of, a spate of…); aquí, el resto del repertorio de C2.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
a · Abundancia				
a **flurry** of activity / speculation / emails	●●○	N	racha repentina y breve, ajetreo	The announcement prompted a flurry of activity.
a **profusion** of flowers / detail	●●○	F	profusión, gran abundancia (descriptivo)	The garden was a profusion of colour.
a **plethora** of options / rules	●●○	F	plétora, exceso; suele sugerir demasiados	a plethora of regulations
a **raft** of measures / proposals	●●○	N	un paquete de (lenguaje periodístico)	The government has announced a raft of measures.
a **host** of reasons / problems	●○○	N	multitud de	for a host of reasons
a **welter** of detail / information	●●○	F	maraña, aluvión confuso	Readers are lost in a welter of detail.
a **glut** of oil / graduates	●●○	N	excedente (de un producto en el mercado)	a glut of cheap oil
a **barrage** / **torrent** of criticism / abuse	●●○	N	aluvión (hostil)	He faced a barrage of questions.
b · Escasez y pizca				
a **dearth** of talent / information	●●○	F	escasez	There is a dearth of qualified teachers.
a **paucity** of data / evidence	●●○	F	escasez (muy formal)	a paucity of reliable data
a **smattering** of French / applause	●●○	N	nociones de; unos pocos	He has a smattering of Italian.
a **grain** of truth	●●●	N	una pizca de verdad	There is a grain of truth in what he says.
a **hint** / **touch** of irony	●●○	N	un toque, un asomo de	with a hint of irony
c · Flujo y serie				
a **steady trickle** of visitors / applicants	●●○	N	un goteo constante; más abundante, a steady stream; masivo, a flood	A steady trickle of visitors came to the exhibition.
a **string** of successes / defeats	●●○	N	racha, serie	a string of hit records
a **catalogue** of errors / disasters	●●●	N	una serie de (errores), con reproche	The inquiry uncovered a catalogue of errors.
a **litany** of complaints	●●○	F	letanía, retahíla	a litany of complaints about the service
d · Grupos de personas y conjuntos				
a **band** of devotees / volunteers	●●○	N	grupo unido por algo; a small band of es frecuente	The show still has a loyal band of devotees.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
a **coterie** of admirers	●●●	F	camarilla, círculo cerrado	a coterie of loyal admirers
a **contingent** of	●●○	N	un contingente, un grupo (de un sitio)	a large contingent of fans
a **body** of evidence / research / understanding	●●○	N	conjunto acumulado (de conocimiento)	There is a growing body of evidence that sleep affects memory.
e · Emociones (además de las de UOE-P1 §3.4)				
a **flicker** of anxiety / doubt	●●○	N	un destello fugaz; a flicker of hope, en UOE-P1	A flicker of anxiety crossed his face.
a **twinge** of guilt / regret	●●○	N	una punzada (leve)	I felt a twinge of guilt.
a **surge** of anger / support	●●○	N	una oleada repentina	a surge of public support
a **wave** of nostalgia / panic	●●○	N	una ola de	A wave of nostalgia swept over her.
a **note** of caution / irritation	●●○	N	un tono de (en la voz o en un texto)	Let me sound a note of caution.

CLAVE

Con los de cantidad (a host, a raft, a number of + plural), el verbo suele ir en plural, por el sentido: a host of problems have arisen. Con a body of, a wealth of, a dearth of y los incontables, en singular: a growing body of evidence suggests.

Ya en otra teoría: a pang of guilt, a flicker of hope, a stroke of luck, a shred of evidence, a spate of attacks, a wealth of experience, a modicum of common sense, a fit of anger (UOE-P1 §3.4)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 1

The inquiry uncovered a _____ of errors, from lost files to missed appointments, that had allowed the problem to go undetected for years.

A catalogue **B** body **C** band **D** glut

Respuesta: A · catalogue**.** A catalogue of errors: una serie de errores, con tono de reproche. La enumeración (from lost files to missed appointments) lo confirma.

B body: body cuantifica conocimiento acumulado (a body of evidence, of research), no errores.

C band: band es un grupo de personas (a band of devotees).

D glut: glut es un excedente de un producto en el mercado (a glut of oil).

10 Preposiciones dependientes

La preposición que exige una palabra no se deduce ni del español ni del significado. Aquí van las de palabras de registro alto que no recogen UOE-P1 §6.1 ni UOE-P2 §6.1. La frontera con LEX-PHV es esta: si el verbo conserva su significado y solo exige la preposición (comply with, reminisce about), es collocation y está aquí; si el conjunto significa otra cosa (make for, smack of), es un prepositional verb y está en LEX-PHV §14.

10.1 · Adjetivo + preposición

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
immune **to**	●●○	N	inmune a (una enfermedad, la crítica); immune from, en sentido jurídico (from prosecution)	He seems immune to criticism.
resistant **to**	●●●	N	resistente a	Some bacteria are resistant to antibiotics.
wary **of**	●●○	N	receloso de; también wary about, menos frecuente	Investors are wary of the new market.
contrary **to**	●●●	N	contrariamente a; contrary to popular belief	Contrary to popular belief, bats are not blind.
tinged **with**	●●●	N	teñido de (un sentimiento)	Her relief was tinged with sadness.
braced **for**	●●●	N	preparado para (algo malo); brace oneself for	The town is braced for more flooding.
steeped **in**	●●●	N	impregnado de (historia, tradición)	a city steeped in history
riddled **with**	●●●	N	plagado de (errores, agujeros, corrupción)	The report is riddled with errors.
rife (**with**)	●●●	N	muy extendido (algo malo); rife with, plagado de	Corruption is rife. · The office was rife with rumours.
beset **by** / **with**	●●○	F	acosado por (problemas)	The project has been beset by delays.
inherent **in**	●●○	F	inherente a; también inherent to	the risks inherent in any investment
integral **to**	●●●	N	esencial para, parte integrante de	Music is integral to the film.
commensurate **with**	●●●	F	acorde con, proporcional a	Salary will be commensurate with experience.
detrimental **to**	●●●	F	perjudicial para	Lack of sleep is detrimental to health.
instrumental **in** -ing	●●●	N	decisivo en	She was instrumental in setting up the charity.
indebted **to** sb (**for** sth)	●●●	N	en deuda con	I am indebted to my colleagues for their advice.
privy **to**	●●●	F	al tanto de (algo confidencial)	Only a few people were privy to the plan.
mindful **of**	●●●	F	consciente de, teniendo presente	Mindful of the risks, they moved slowly.
dismissive **of**	●●●	N	desdeñoso con	He was dismissive of my concerns.
scathing **about** / **of**	●●○	N	mordaz con	Critics were scathing about the film.
bereft **of**	●●●	F	desprovisto de	The debate was bereft of new ideas.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
incompatible **with**	●●●	N	incompatible con	The plan is incompatible with our aims.

10.2 · Verbo + preposición sin significado propio

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
comply **with**	●●●	F	cumplir (normas, una orden); no *comply the rules	All products must comply with safety standards.
reminisce **about**	●●●	N	rememorar con nostalgia	They spent the evening reminiscing about their student days.
compete **with** sb **for** sth	●●●	N	competir con alguien por algo; compete for sb's attention	Dozens of apps compete for our attention.
vie **with** sb **for** sth	●●●	F	rivalizar con alguien por algo	The two cities vie with each other for tourists.
conform **to** / **with**	●●○	N	ajustarse a (normas, expectativas)	The building does not conform to safety regulations.
contend **with**	●●●	N	lidiar con, hacer frente a (dificultades)	Farmers have had to contend with two years of drought.
subscribe **to**	●●●	N	suscribir, compartir (una opinión, una teoría)	I don't subscribe to the view that money brings happiness.
elaborate **on**	●●●	N	dar detalles, desarrollar	Could you elaborate on that point?
dabble **in**	●●●	N	hacer sus pinitos en	He dabbled in politics in his youth.
bask **in**	●●●	N	disfrutar de (la gloria, el sol, los elogios)	She basked in the praise.
wallow **in**	●●●	N	regodearse en (la autocompasión)	There is no point wallowing in self-pity.
marvel **at**	●●●	N	maravillarse de	Visitors marvel at the detail of the carvings.
testify / attest **to**	●●○	F	dar fe de, demostrar	The crowds testify to the festival's popularity.
emanate **from**	●●●	F	emanar de, proceder de	The proposals emanate from the finance ministry.
preside **over**	●●●	F	presidir; estar al frente durante (un periodo)	She presided over a period of rapid growth.
collude **with**	●●●	F	confabularse con	Officials were accused of colluding with smugglers.
enquire **into** / **about** / **after**	●●○	N	investigar / preguntar por / interesarse por (la salud de alguien)	She enquired after your mother.

10.3 · Sustantivo + preposición

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
a ceiling **on**	●●●	N	un tope a (precios, gasto)	a ceiling on rent increases
a cap / curb **on**	●●●	N	un límite / freno a	a cap on bankers' bonuses
a monopoly **on** / **of**	●●○	N	monopolio de; have a monopoly on: tener la exclusiva de	No party has a monopoly on wisdom.
a corrective **to**	●●●	F	un contrapeso, una corrección a (una idea extendida)	The book is a welcome corrective to the usual myths.
an antidote **to**	●●●	N	antídoto contra	Laughter is the best antidote to stress.
a prelude **to**	●●●	N	preludio de	The talks were a prelude to a full agreement.
a backlash **against**	●●●	N	reacción en contra	a backlash against the new tax
a disregard **for**	●●○	N	desprecio por, falta de respeto a; también of	a blatant disregard for safety
contempt **for**	●●●	N	desprecio hacia	He made no secret of his contempt for politicians.
a predilection **for**	●●●	F	predilección por	a predilection for long words
a propensity **for** / **to**	●●○	F	propensión a (for + sust.; to + infinitivo)	a propensity to exaggerate
an affinity **with** / **for**	●●○	N	afinidad con	She felt an affinity with the poor.
an aptitude **for**	●●●	N	aptitud para	He showed an early aptitude for music.
a testament **to**	●●●	N	prueba de, testimonio de	Her recovery is a testament to her courage.
a hallmark **of**	●●●	N	sello distintivo de	Clarity is the hallmark of good writing.
a recipe **for** disaster	●●●	N	receta para el desastre	Mixing work and friendship is a recipe for disaster.
an exemption **from**	●●●	N	exención de	an exemption from the new tax

10.4 · Verbo + objeto + preposición

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
owe sth **to** sb	●●●	N	deber algo a alguien (también el éxito, la vida); sin preposición, owe sb sth; owe it to sb to do sth: deberle a alguien hacer algo	She owes her success to her first teacher.
hail sb / sth **as**	●●●	N	aclamar como, saludar como	The film was hailed as a masterpiece.
denounce sb / sth **as**	●●●	N	denunciar como, tachar de	Critics denounced the plan as unworkable.
dismiss sth **as**	●●●	N	despachar, descartar por	He dismissed the idea as absurd.
brand sb (**as**) sth	●●○	N	tachar de, tildar de	She was branded a traitor.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
regard sb / sth **with** suspicion / disdain	●●○	N	mirar con recelo / desdén; regard sb as, considerar	Newcomers were regarded with suspicion.
prompt sb **to** do sth	●●●	N	llevar a alguien a, impulsar; prompt sth: provocar	The scandal prompted him to resign.
spare sb sth / be spared sth	●●●	N	ahorrar algo a alguien (un mal rato, los detalles); librarse de algo; dos objetos, sin preposición	I'll spare you the details. · The town was spared the worst of the storm.
credit sb **with** sth	●●○	N	atribuir a alguien (el mérito de algo); también credit sth to sb	She is credited with saving the company.
equate X **with** Y	●●●	N	equiparar X a Y	Many people equate success with wealth.
liken X **to** Y	●●●	N	comparar X con Y (por su semejanza)	Critics likened her to Austen.
pit X **against** Y	●●●	N	enfrentar a X con Y	The dispute pitted neighbour against neighbour.
entrust sb **with** sth / sth **to** sb	●●○	N	confiar algo a alguien	She was entrusted with the keys.
burden sb **with** sth	●●●	N	cargar a alguien con	I don't want to burden you with my problems.
implicate sb **in** sth	●●●	N	implicar en (un delito)	He was implicated in the fraud.
rob sb **of** sth	●●●	N	privar de (sentido figurado)	Injury robbed him of a place in the final.
dissuade sb **from** -ing	●●●	N	disuadir de	Nothing could dissuade her from going.
absolve sb **of** / **from** sth	●●○	F	absolver de, eximir de	The report absolves the pilot of any blame.

10.5 · La misma palabra con dos preposiciones

Algunas palabras cambian de sentido según la preposición. En la Part 2 la pista está en el complemento; en la Part 1, la opción correcta puede ser la misma palabra que en otra frase sería un error.

Palabra	Con…	Con…
glad	of + sust.: agradecer tener algo (glad of the company, of a rest)	about / that: contento por lo ocurrido
anxious	about: preocupado por	for + sust. / to + inf.: deseoso de (anxious for news)
concerned	about / for: preocupado por	with: que trata de (The study is concerned with…)
familiar	with: conocer algo (I'm familiar with the text)	to: resultar conocido a alguien (The text is familiar to me)
compare	to: equiparar, por semejanza (como liken)	with: cotejar semejanzas y diferencias
sorry	for sb: compadecer (feel sorry for)	about sth: lamentar

Palabra	Con…	Con…
impatient	with sb: impaciente con	for sth: deseoso de (impatient for change)
agree	with sb / una opinión; to una propuesta (consentir)	on un asunto: ponerse de acuerdo sobre
immune	to: inmune a (enfermedad, crítica)	from: exento de (prosecution, tax)
result	in: dar como resultado	from: ser consecuencia de

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Los sustantivos no siempre heredan la preposición del verbo o del adjetivo: contempt for pero contemptuous of; disregard for pero disregard sth (transitivo); immune to pero immunity from en sentido legal. Aprende cada palabra con la suya.

Ya en otra teoría: oblivious to, an insight into, engrossed in, accountable to, tantamount to, conducive to, prone to (UOE-P1 §6.1) · discuss sth, emphasise sth (UOE-P1 §6.3) · averse to, akin to, adept at, devoid of, fraught with, adhere to, refrain from, succumb to, capitalise on (UOE-P2 §6.1) · object to, insist on, accuse sb of (UOE-P4 §3.8) · make for, cater for, part with, grapple with (LEX-PHV §14)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 2

However much they complain about the noise, few of the town's older residents are immune _____ the charm of the Saturday market.

Respuesta: TO

Pista: immune to + un sentimiento, una enfermedad o la crítica. From no vale: immune from es jurídico (immune from prosecution).

11 Frases preposicionales y patrones fijos

Frases que funcionan como un adverbio (under way, at modest cost) y patrones con un infinitivo o un -ing que no admiten cambios (too close to call, a gamble worth taking). En la Part 2 el hueco suele ser la preposición o el artículo, que en muchas de ellas falta.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
a · Frases preposicionales				
under way	●●●	N	en marcha; sin artículo (en americano, a menudo underway)	Work on the new bridge is already under way.
under review / scrutiny / threat	●●○	N	en revisión / bajo escrutinio / amenazado	The policy is under review.
under the guise of	●●●	F	bajo la apariencia de	He gathered information under the guise of friendship.
at modest / little / great **cost**	●●○	N	a un coste moderado / bajo / alto; sin artículo; con cifra, at a cost of £5m	The museum was restored at modest cost.
by a clear / wide / narrow **margin**	●●○	N	por un margen claro / amplio / estrecho	The motion was carried by a clear margin.

Combinación	Fij.	Reg.	Significado	Ejemplo
with grim **satisfaction** / determination	●●○	N	con una satisfacción sombría (al ver confirmado algo malo)	She noted with grim satisfaction that her rival had failed.
with great / considerable **flair**	●●○	N	con mucho estilo y talento	The play was staged with great flair.
with the full force of (the law)	●●●	N	con todo el peso de (la ley); feel the full force of	Offenders will feel the full force of the law.
at the forefront of	●●●	N	a la vanguardia de	The university is at the forefront of cancer research.
in the throes of	●●●	F	en plena (crisis, mudanza)	The country is in the throes of an economic crisis.
on the back of	●●●	N	a raíz de, gracias a (británico)	Profits rose on the back of strong exports.
in tandem (with)	●●●	N	a la par (con), en paralelo	The two schemes run in tandem.
at the behest of	●●●	F	a instancias de	The inquiry was set up at the behest of the families.
at the helm	●●●	N	al timón, al frente	With a new chairman at the helm, the club recovered.
in earnest	●●●	N	en serio, de verdad (empezar algo)	The campaign began in earnest in May.
in abeyance	●●●	F	en suspenso	The plan is in abeyance until next year.
at sb's **discretion**	●●●	F	a criterio de	Refunds are given at the manager's discretion.
b · Patrones fijos de complemento				
(too) **close** / **difficult to call**	●●○	N	imposible de pronosticar (un resultado igualado)	The election is too close to call.
hard / **difficult to come by**	●●○	N	difícil de conseguir	Good plumbers are hard to come by.
a gamble / risk **worth taking**	●●○	N	un riesgo que vale la pena correr; worth + -ing, nunca *worth to take	Expanding abroad was a gamble worth taking.
count for very little / nothing / a great deal	●●○	N	valer muy poco / nada / mucho	In this business, experience counts for very little.
be **at pains to** do sth	●●●	F	esforzarse mucho por (dejar claro algo)	She was at pains to stress that nothing had been decided.
be **hard pressed to** do sth	●●●	N	verse en apuros para	You would be hard pressed to find a better hotel.
stand to gain / lose	●●●	N	tener mucho que ganar / perder	Small farmers stand to lose the most.
be **loath to** do sth	●●●	F	ser reacio a	He was loath to admit defeat.
not to be sniffed at	●●●	I	nada despreciable	A 5% pay rise is not to be sniffed at.

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El artículo es parte de la forma y la Part 2 lo aprovecha: under way, at modest cost, in earnest e in tandem van sin él; at the helm y at the forefront of, con él. Y loath (reacio, adjetivo) no es loathe (detestar, verbo): He was loath to leave / He loathes leaving.

Ya en otra teoría: in the wake of, in the light of, at odds with, by virtue of, in keeping with, on the strength of, in the face of, in lieu of (UOE-P1 §4.3) · by no means, at large, at length, to no avail (UOE-P2 §6.3) · with a view to, regardless of, at the expense of (UOE-P4 §5.4) · worth sb's while, at short notice (UOE-P4 §7)

ÍTEM MODELO · PART 4

The two candidates are level in the polls, so nobody can predict who will win the election.

CALL

With the two candidates level in the polls, the election _____.

Respuesta: IS TOO CLOSE TO CALL (5 palabras)

También: IS IMPOSSIBLE TO CALL (4)

Qué se puntúa: el verbo en presente (is) y el patrón fijo con su colocado (too close to call o impossible to call). IS DIFFICULT TO CALL no puntúa esa mitad: rebaja el nobody can de la frase 1.

12 Tabla de repaso por palabra base

Orden alfabético por la palabra base, que es la que da la frase y la que hay que asociar con su colocado. Para repasar en enero: lee la base, intenta recordar el colocado (y la preposición, si la lleva) y solo entonces mira la combinación. Incluye las combinaciones remitidas a otras teorías: P1, P2, P3 y P4 = UOE-P1…P4; IDI = LEX-IDI; PHV = LEX-PHV, con su apartado.

	Palabras base y combinaciones
A	**abeyance** in abeyance §11 · **absent** conspicuously absent §4.2 · **absolve** absolve sb of / from sth §10.4 · **account** take sth into account P4 5.1 · **accountable** accountable to P1 6.1 · **accuse** accuse sb of P4 3.8 · **activity** a flurry of activity / speculation / emails §9 · **adept** adept at P2 6.1 · **adhere** adhere to P2 6.1 · **admirers** a coterie of admirers §9
	admission a public admission / apology §5 · **admit** freely admit / acknowledge §4.1; readily admit P1 3.3 · **advised** ill-advised P3 7.4 · **affinity** an affinity with / for §10.3 · **agree** wholeheartedly agree / support §4.1 · **akin** akin to P2 6.1 · **alight** keep sth alight §6 · **allowances** make allowances for P4 5.1 · **amends** make amends (to sb) (for sth) §7 · **amused** mildly amused / surprised / irritating §3.1
	anger a surge of anger / support §9; a fit of anger P1 3.4 · **antidote** an antidote to §10.3 · **anxiety** a flicker of anxiety / doubt §9 · **appreciate** fully appreciate / understand §4.1 · **aptitude** an aptitude for §10.3 · **argument** a cogent argument / case §5 · **assumption** an unspoken assumption / rule §5 · **attacks** a spate of attacks P1 3.4 · **attention** draw attention to P4 5.1; hold sb's attention / interest §7 · **attitudes** harden attitudes / one's stance §6
	avail to no avail P2 6.3 · **available** readily available P1 3.3 · **averse** averse to P2 6.1 · **avoid** narrowly avoid / escape / miss / defeat §4.1 · **aware** acutely aware / embarrassed §3.1
B	**back** on the back of §11 · **backlash** a backlash against §10.3 · **balance** strike a balance P1 3.1 · **ban** an outright ban / winner / majority §5; a blanket ban §5; impose / lift a ban / restrictions §6 · **bankrupt** go missing / bankrupt / blind §8 · **bask** bask in §10.2 · **behest** at the behest of §11 · **bereft** bereft of §10.1 · **beset** beset by / with §10.1 · **bit** a bit of a + noun P4 7

	Palabras base y combinaciones
	blame lay / put / place the blame (squarely) on sb §6; bear / shoulder / take the blame (for) §6; apportion blame §6; shift / pass the blame (onto sb) §6; squarely blame P1 3.3 · **block** a sticking point / a stumbling block §5 · **braced** braced for §10.1 · **brand** brand sb (as) sth §10.4 · **brilliant** quietly brilliant / confident / effective §3.1 · **brunt** bear the brunt of P1 3.1 · **burden** burden sb with sth §10.4
C	**call** (too) close / difficult to call §11 · **calm** outwardly calm / confident §3.1 · **cap** a cap / curb on §10.3 · **capitalise** capitalise on P2 6.1 · **cater** cater for PHV 14 · **caution** a note of caution / irritation §9 · **ceiling** a ceiling on §10.3 · **chance** a slim chance P1 3.2 · **check** keep sth in check §7 · **circle** a vicious circle §5
	claim lay claim to §7 · **close** dangerously close / low §3.1 · **collude** collude with §10.2 · **come by** hard / difficult to come by §11 · **comeback** stage / make / mount a comeback §6 · **commensurate** commensurate with §10.1 · **common sense** a modicum of common sense P1 3.4 · **community** close-knit / tight-knit community §4.2 · **comparison** bear comparison with §7 · **compete** compete with sb for sth §10.2
	competition stiff competition P1 3.2 · **complaint** lodge / file a complaint §6 · **complaints** a litany of complaints §9 · **comply** comply with §10.2 · **compromise** strike / reach a compromise §6 · **concern** voice a view / concern / doubts §6 · **conclusion** a foregone conclusion P1 3.2 · **conducive** conducive to P1 6.1 · **conform** conform to / with §10.2 · **contempt** contempt for §10.3
	contend contend with §10.2 · **contention** a bone of contention IDI 8 · **contested** hotly contested / debated / disputed §4.2 · **contract** a lucrative contract / deal / career §5; win a contract / an award / sb's support §6 · **contrary** contrary to §10.1 · **controversy** spark controversy / a debate / protests §6 · **corrective** a corrective to §10.3 · **cost** at modest / little / great cost §11 · **costly** prove costly / fatal / elusive §8 · **costs** running costs §5; hidden costs / charges §5; incur costs P1 3.1
	count count for very little / nothing / a great deal §11 · **course** run its course §7 · **court** go to court (over sth) §6 · **cow** a cash cow IDI 13 · **craft** learn / hone one's craft §6 · **credence** give credence to §7 · **credit** credit sb with sth §10.4 · **critic** a vocal critic / minority §5 · **criticise** sharply criticise / rise / fall §4.1; roundly criticise P1 3.3 · **criticism** draw criticism / fire §6; level criticism / accusations at sb §6; a barrage / torrent of criticism / abuse §9
	curb a cap / curb on §10.3 · **curve** a steep learning curve §5
D	**dabble** dabble in §10.2 · **data** a paucity of data / evidence §9 · **deal** clinch a deal / victory / title §6 · **debate** a heated debate / argument §5 · **denounce** denounce sb / sth as §10.4 · **deny** categorically deny / reject / rule out §4.1; strenuously deny / object §4.1; vehemently deny P1 3.3 · **deserved** richly deserved / rewarded §4.2 · **detail** a welter of detail / information §9 · **detrimental** detrimental to §10.1 · **devoid** devoid of P2 6.1
	devotees a band of devotees / volunteers §9 · **different** markedly different / better §3.1 · **difficult** notoriously difficult / unreliable §3.1 · **disappointed** bitterly disappointed P1 3.3 · **discretion** at sb's discretion §11 · **discuss** discuss sth P1 6.3 · **dismiss** dismiss sth as §10.4 · **dismissive** dismissive of §10.1 · **dispute** an acrimonious / a bitter dispute §5 · **disregard** a disregard for §10.3
	disservice do sb a disservice §7 · **dissuade** dissuade sb from -ing §10.4 · **dividends** pay dividends §7 · **dormant** lie dormant / idle / empty §8 · **doubts** harbour doubts P1 3.1 · **dry** run dry / short / high / wild §8
E	**earnest** in earnest §11 · **edge** have / give sb an edge (over) §7 · **effect** a knock-on effect §5; take effect §7 · **effort** make an effort P4 4 · **elaborate** elaborate on §10.2 · **elephant** a white elephant IDI 13 · **emanate** emanate from §10.2 · **emphasise** emphasise sth P1 6.3 · **endless** seemingly endless / innocuous §3.1 · **enemy** a common enemy / cause §5
	engrossed engrossed in P1 6.1 · **enjoyable** thoroughly enjoyable / deserved / ashamed §3.1 · **enquire** enquire into / about / after §10.2 · **entrust** entrust sb with sth / sth to sb §10.4 · **equate** equate X with Y §10.4 · **errors** a catalogue of errors / disasters §9 · **estimate** a rough estimate P1 3.2 · **evidence** slender / slim / flimsy evidence §5; damning evidence / verdict / report §5; compelling / hard evidence §5; a body of evidence / research / understanding §9; a shred of evidence P1 3.4 · **exaggerate** greatly appreciate / exaggerate §4.1 · **exception** take exception to P4 5.1

	Palabras base y combinaciones
	excuse a convenient excuse / scapegoat §5 · **exemption** an exemption from §10.3 · **expense** at the expense of P4 5.4 · **expensive** prohibitively expensive / high §3.1 · **experience** a wealth of experience P1 3.4
F	**face** keep a straight face §7; in the face of P1 4.3 · **fact** a settled fact / view §5 · **fall** fall (hardest / heavily) on sb §6 · **false** patently false / absurd / obvious §3.1 · **familiar** vaguely familiar / aware §3.1 · **fans** a contingent of §9 · **far** far / considerably + comparative P4 3.7 · **fears** deep-seated / deep-rooted fears / prejudice §5; allay fears / concerns / suspicions §6 · **feat** no mean + sust. §3.3 · **fee** a nominal fee / charge §5; waive a fee / one's right §6
	field day have a field day §7 · **fine** a hefty fine / bill / price §5 · **flair** with great / considerable flair §11 · **flat** fall flat IDI 3 · **flawed** fundamentally flawed / different §3.1 · **flowers** a profusion of flowers / detail §9 · **force** with the full force of (the law) §11 · **forefront** at the forefront of §11 · **foundations** lay the foundations (for) §7; rest on narrow / shaky foundations §7 · **fraught** fraught with P2 6.1
	free break free / loose §8 · **French** a smattering of French / applause §9 · **fruit** bear fruit §7
G	**gamble** a gamble / risk worth taking §11 · **generalisation** a sweeping generalisation P1 3.2 · **gesture** a token gesture / payment §5 · **grapple** grapple with PHV 14 · **grievances** air one's views / grievances §6 · **guarded** heavily guarded / subsidised / indebted §4.2 · **guilt** a twinge of guilt / regret §9; a pang of guilt P1 3.4 · **guilty** plead guilty / not guilty §8 · **guise** under the guise of §11
H	**habit** make a habit of -ing §7 · **hail** hail sb / sth as §10.4 · **hallmark** a hallmark of §10.3 · **headway** make headway IDI 3 · **heed** pay / take heed (of / to) §7 · **helm** at the helm §11 · **high** stubbornly high / persistent §3.1; run dry / short / high / wild §8 · **hollow** ring true / hollow §8 · **homesickness** acute homesickness / anxiety / embarrassment §5 · **honest** refreshingly honest / free of jargon §3.1
	hope a flicker of hope P1 3.4 · **hurt** deeply hurt P1 3.3
I	**idle** lie dormant / idle / empty §8 · **immune** immune to §10.1 · **implicate** implicate sb in sth §10.4 · **important** vitally / critically important §3.1 · **inadequate** woefully inadequate / ill-prepared §3.1 · **inch** every inch a + sust. §3.3 · **income** disposable income §5 · **incompatible** incompatible with §10.1 · **indebted** indebted to sb (for sth) §10.1 · **independent** fiercely independent / loyal / competitive §3.1
	inherent inherent in §10.1 · **inroads** make inroads into / on §7 · **insight** an insight into P1 6.1 · **insist** insist on P4 3.8 · **instrumental** instrumental in -ing §10.1 · **integral** integral to §10.1 · **interest** a vested interest P1 3.2 · **irony** a hint / touch of irony §9 · **issue** take issue with P4 5.1
J	**justice** do justice to sb / sth §7
K	**keeping** in keeping with P1 4.3 · **killing** make a killing §7
L	**large** at large P2 6.3 · **law** enforce a law / rule / ban §6 · **learning** lifelong learning §5 · **length** at length P2 6.3 · **liability** admit liability §6 · **lie** give the lie to §7 · **lieu** in lieu of P1 4.3 · **light** in the light of P1 4.3 · **liken** liken X to Y §10.4 · **link** a tenuous link / connection §5
	lip service pay lip service to IDI 8 · **living** make / earn a living §7 · **loath** be loath to do sth §11 · **luck** a stroke of luck P1 3.4
M	**majority** an overwhelming / a vast majority §5 · **make** make for PHV 14 · **margin** by a clear / wide / narrow margin §11 · **marvel** marvel at §10.2 · **means** by no means P2 6.3 · **measures** a raft of measures / proposals §9 · **memories** cherished / fond memories §5 · **memory** jog sb's memory P1 3.1 · **mindful** mindful of §10.1 · **minority** a sizeable / significant minority §5
	missed sorely missed P1 3.3 · **missing** go missing / bankrupt / blind §8 · **monopoly** a monopoly on / of §10.3 · **more** more of a X (than a Y) §3.3 · **most** make the most of P4 5.1 · **moving** profoundly moving / grateful / shocked §3.1 · **much** not much of a + sust. §3.3
N	**name** a household name §5 · **net** a safety net §5 · **nightmare** a bureaucratic / logistical nightmare §5 · **nostalgia** a wave of nostalgia / panic §9 · **notice** at short notice P4 7

	Palabras base y combinaciones
O	**object** object to P4 3.8 · **oblivious** oblivious to P1 6.1 · **obvious** painfully obvious P1 3.3 · **odds** at odds with P1 4.3 · **office** hold office / talks / an inquiry §7 · **oil** a glut of oil / graduates §9 · **options** weigh up the options / the evidence §6; a plethora of options / rules §9 · **outdated** hopelessly outdated / lost / in love §3.1 · **overdue** long overdue / awaited / forgotten §4.2 · **owe** owe sth to sb §10.4
P	**pace** keep pace with P4 5.1 · **pains** be at pains to do sth §11 · **part** part with PHV 14 · **pause** give sb pause (for thought) §7 · **pit** pit X against Y §10.4 · **playing field** a level playing field §5 · **point** a moot point §5; a turning point §5; a sticking point / a stumbling block §5; make a point of -ing P4 5.1 · **populated** densely / sparsely populated §4.2 · **power** wield power P1 3.1 · **precedence** take precedence (over) §7
	precedent set a precedent §6 · **predilection** a predilection for §10.3 · **prelude** a prelude to §10.3 · **preside** preside over §10.2 · **pressed** be hard pressed to do sth §11 · **pressure** exert pressure P1 3.1 · **price** pay the price (for) §7 · **privy** privy to §10.1 · **prized** highly prized / acclaimed / skilled §4.2 · **problem** compound a problem / the effects §6
	prompt prompt sb to do sth §10.4 · **prone** prone to P1 6.1 · **propensity** a propensity for / to §10.3 · **publicised** much-publicised / -loved / -needed / -maligned §4.2
Q	**question** a vexed question / issue §5 · **quite** quite a, such a P2 3
R	**reasons** a host of reasons / problems §9 · **recipe** a recipe for disaster §10.3 · **recollection** a vague / hazy / distant recollection §5 · **record** a track record §5 · **refrain** refrain from P2 6.1 · **refuse** steadfastly refuse / maintain §4.1; flatly refuse P1 3.3 · **regard** regard sb / sth with suspicion / disdain §10.4 · **regarded** highly regarded P1 3.3 · **regardless** regardless of P4 5.4 · **rely** heavily criticise / rely on / depend on §4.1
	remember vividly remember / recall / describe §4.1; dimly / vaguely remember / recall §4.1; fondly remember / recall §4.1 · **reminisce** reminisce about §10.2 · **report** commission a report / study / artist §6 · **resemblance** bear a passing / striking resemblance to §7; bear a resemblance to P4 4 · **resemble** closely resemble / follow / monitor §4.1 · **resentment** breed resentment / contempt / complacency §6 · **reservations** have reservations (about) §7 · **resistance** meet with success / resistance §6 · **resistant** resistant to §10.1 · **respect** grudging respect / admiration §5
	responsibility claim / accept responsibility (for) §6 · **restore** painstakingly restore / reconstruct §4.1 · **review** under review / scrutiny / threat §11 · **rewards** reap the rewards / benefits §6 · **riddled** riddled with §10.1 · **ridiculous** faintly ridiculous / pompous / absurd §3.1 · **rife** rife (with) §10.1 · **rights** hard-won rights / independence §5 · **rise** give rise to P4 5.1 · **risk** carry a risk / a penalty §6; run the risk of -ing §6
	risky inherently risky / unstable §3.1 · **rob** rob sb of sth §10.4 · **rooted** deeply rooted / ingrained / entrenched §4.2 · **rules** flout the rules / the law §6
S	**satisfaction** with grim satisfaction / determination §11 · **say** give sb a say (in sth) §7; have a say in P4 5.1 · **scathing** scathing about / of §10.1 · **scrutiny** under review / scrutiny / threat §11 · **sensible** eminently sensible / reasonable / qualified §3.1 · **setback** suffer a setback / defeat §6 · **shortage** an acute shortage P1 3.2 · **silent** fall silent / ill / asleep §8 · **similar** strikingly similar / beautiful §3.1 · **simple** deceptively simple / spacious §3.1
	skill keep a skill / a tradition alive §6 · **slot** fit sb into a slot §6 · **sniffed** not to be sniffed at §11 · **something** something of a + sust. §3.3 · **sour** turn sour / nasty §8 · **spare** spare sb sth / be spared sth §10.4 · **speculation** fuel speculation / fears / anger §6 · **stance** take a stand / stance (on) §7 · **stand** stand to gain / lose §11 · **statement** make a statement §7
	steady hold steady §8 · **steeped** steeped in §10.1 · **stick** make sth stick §8 · **stock** take stock (of) §7 · **strength** on the strength of P1 4.3 · **subscribe** subscribe to §10.2 · **successes** a string of successes / defeats §9 · **succumb** succumb to P2 6.1 · **sum** a tidy sum / profit §5 · **supporter** a staunch supporter / ally / opponent §5
	sway hold sway IDI 7 · **symbol** a status symbol §5

	Palabras base y combinaciones
T	**tabs** keep tabs on §7 · **talent** a dearth of talent / information §9 · **talks** hold office / talks / an inquiry §7 · **tandem** in tandem (with) §11 · **tantamount** tantamount to P1 6.1 · **taste** acquire a taste for §6 · **tension** simmering resentment / tension §5 · **testament** a testament to §10.3 · **testify** testify / attest to §10.2 · **theory** rival strategies / theories / claims §5
	thin wear thin §8 · **threat** pose a threat P1 3.1 · **threshold** cross the threshold §6 · **throes** in the throes of §11 · **tinged** tinged with §10.1 · **toll** a heavy toll P1 3.2; take its toll on P4 5.1 · **track** keep track of §7; lose track of P4 5.1 · **tradition** keep a skill / a tradition alive §6; uphold a tradition / a principle §6; break with tradition §6 · **tribute** pay tribute to P4 5.1 · **trickle** a steady trickle of visitors / applicants §9
	true hold true / good (for) §8; ring true / hollow §8; come true / loose / undone §8 · **truth** a grain of truth §9 · **turnaround** a dramatic turnaround §5
U	**unhelpful** singularly unhelpful / ill-suited §3.1 · **unlikely** highly unlikely P1 3.3 · **unnoticed** go unnoticed / unpunished / unchallenged §8 · **utmost** do one's utmost §7
V	**veiled** thinly veiled / disguised §4.2 · **vent** give vent to §7 · **very much** very much a + sust. §3.3 · **victory** a landslide victory §5 · **vie** vie with sb for sth §10.2 · **view** voice a view / concern / doubts §6; take the view that §7; with a view to P4 5.4 · **virtue** by virtue of P1 4.3
W	**wake** in the wake of P1 4.3 · **wallow** wallow in §10.2 · **wary** wary of §10.1 · **way** under way §11 · **weary** grow weary / tired of §8 · **weight** carry weight IDI 7 · **while** worth sb's while P4 7 · **windfall** a windfall tax / profit §5 · **wisdom** conventional / received wisdom §5 · **witness** bear witness to §7
	wonders do / work wonders (for) §7